



GRIOT^{OS}

The storyteller who remembers you.

BRAND SYSTEM V3 · FOR REVIEW · OCTOBER 2026

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THE FAMILY

Two marks, two jobs. Like the adidas Trefoil and the three bars.



A · THE GRIOT · SIGNATURE

Introduces GRIOT. Once per screen.

Page hero · app splash · social profile · decks · WhatsApp card · merchandise



C · THE G · SYMBOL

Repeats everywhere. Reads at 16 px.

Browser tab · app icon · spinner · chat avatar · buttons · partner versions

WHERE IT COMES FROM

A griot is a library that walks.
GRIOT is built to be one.

In the Mande world of West Africa (Mali, Senegal, Guinea, The Gambia), the griot, or jeli, keeps a community's memory: family histories, counsel for leaders before they decide, and the stories that hold people together, often sung with the 21-string kora.

THE GRIOT

IN GRIOT OS

Keeper of memory

Memory: your goals and facts

Adviser to leaders

Counsel: the nine-step protocol

Historian

Decisions: what was decided, and why

Storyteller

Narrative: pitches and stories

The kora's strings

Voice: the speaking animation

« *En Afrique, quand un vieillard meurt, c'est une bibliothèque qui brûle.* »

“In Africa, when an elder dies, a library burns.”

Amadou Hampâté Bâ (1901–1991)

Malian writer and historian of oral tradition. Popular form of his words at UNESCO, 1960.

GRIOT is the library that never burns: it remembers every client, every goal, every decision.

WHAT CHANGED IN A

From a plain gold ring to a band with a story.



BEFORE · V2

A plain gold ring



NOW · V3

Bogolan band on barkcloth brown



Nine protocol dots

Understand to Learn. They light in turn while GRIOT thinks.



Converging arrows

A bogolan border mark: many voices, gathered.

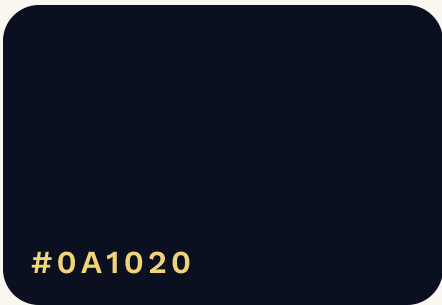


The cross

The crossroads where a decision is made.

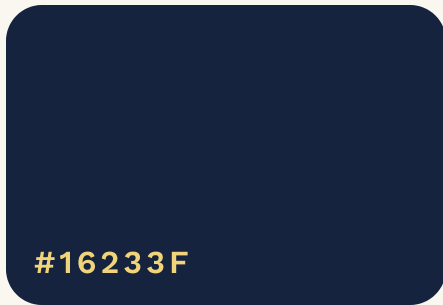
COLOUR AND TEXTURE

Midnight and Gold, with one new colour from home.



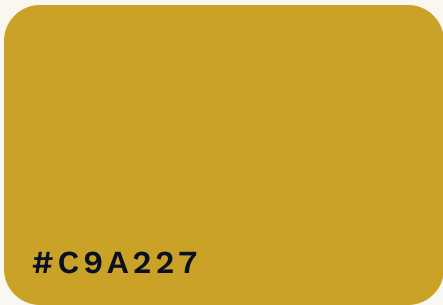
Midnight

Hero bands, the badge ground



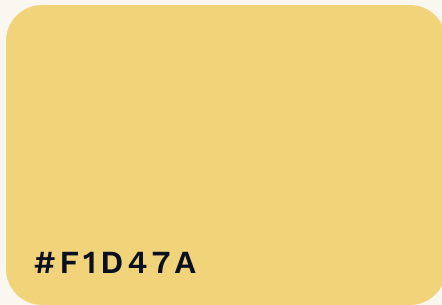
Navy

Structure and buttons



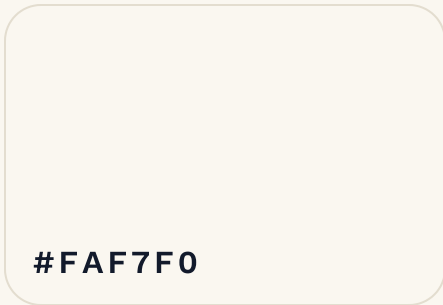
Gold

Rims, highlights, the score ring



Gold light

Bogolan marks, key words on dark



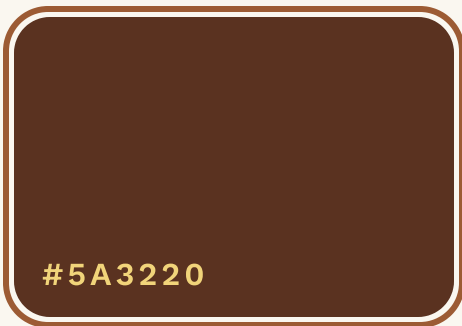
Ivory

Reading surfaces



Barkcloth

New · accent panels and strips



Barkcloth deep

New · A's band



BARKCLOTH · LUBUGO

Made in Buganda from the inner bark of the mutuba tree, beaten into cloth for centuries.

UNESCO lists barkcloth making in Uganda as Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (2008).

In GRIOT: the band in A, and at most one panel or strip per screen. Never behind body text.

SLOGANS

Four lines, set as real lockups.

MY PICK · EVERYDAY LINE



GRIOT^{OS}

The storyteller who remembers you.

Everyday tagline: logo, GRIOT page, app.



GRIOT^{OS}

A library that never burns.

Manifesto and campaigns, credited to Hampâté Bâ.



GRIOT^{OS}

Africa's oldest intelligence, reimagined.

Launch, press releases, conference stages.



GRIOT^{OS}

Ancient memory. Modern counsel.

Investor and partner decks, LinkedIn.

THINKING

A proverb at every step.

While GRIOT works, each of its nine steps shows a proverb. These hold the places for your own nine Luganda or Runyankore engero.

1 • UNDERSTAND

Akili ni nywele, kila mtu ana zake.

Wisdom is like hair: everyone has their own.

Swahili • East Africa

2 • CONTEXT

Wisdom is like a baobab tree: no one person can embrace it.

Context comes from many people, not one.

Ewe • Ghana and Togo (English rendering)

3 • EVIDENCE

Until the lions have their own historians, the history of the hunt will glorify the hunter.

Ask whose story the evidence tells.

African proverb, as quoted by Chinua Achebe (1994)

4 • DIAGNOSE

Usipoziba ufa utajenga ukuta.

If you don't mend the crack, you will be building a wall.

Swahili • East Africa

5 • OPTIONS

Penye nia pana njia.

Where there is a will, there is a way.

Swahili • East Africa

6 • RECOMMEND

Asiyesikia la mkuu huzunjika guni.

Whoever ignores the elder's counsel breaks a leg.

Swahili • East Africa

7 • EXECUTE

Agali azwamu ge galuma enyama.

Teeth that work together are the ones that bite the meat.

Luganda • Uganda

8 • MEASURE

Haba na haba hujaza kibaba.

Little by little fills the measure.

Swahili • East Africa

9 • LEARN

Se wo zwere fi na zwo sankofa a yenkyi.

It is not wrong to go back for what you forgot. (Sankofa)

Akan • Ghana

USAGE

When to use A, when to use C.



A • the Griot

- Introduces GRIOT: hero, splash, profile, deck cover, share card.
- Once per screen, at most.
- Smallest: 48 px on screen, 20 mm in print. Smaller, use C.
- Clear space: a quarter of its width on every side.
- Wherever the face answers in chat, “AI” sits beside it.



C • the G

- Repeats: browser tab, app icon, spinner, chat avatar, buttons.
- Down to 16 px; bold cut at 32 px and under.
- Face-free: the version for partner and white-label use.
- Stays clean: no band, no motifs. The heritage lives in A.

✗ A and C side by side

One introduces, the other repeats.
Together they compete.

✗ Recoloured band or face

Keep gold, barkcloth and midnight
exactly as drawn.

✗ A on a photo or busy ground

Midnight, navy, ivory or barkcloth
backgrounds only.

✗ Bogolan as wallpaper

The marks live in the band. Behind
text they become costume.